

PrimaryBid

Designing high-trust investment experiences for regulated financial markets

Role

Senior Product Designer

Company

PrimaryBid

Timeline

16 months

Focus

Fintech / Regulated UX / High-trust product design / Design systems

Overview

Investing in public offerings is traditionally complex.

Retail investors are often excluded from institutional financial opportunities due to:

- fragmented onboarding
- compliance-heavy workflows
- financial jargon
- low transparency
- operational complexity

At PrimaryBid, I worked across regulated investment journeys designed to make public market investing more accessible while maintaining the trust, clarity and compliance required in financial products.

I led the design of responsive investment workflows, broker tools and scalable design systems across high-risk financial experiences.

The challenge was not simply simplifying interfaces.

It was designing confidence within highly regulated environments.

Why this mattered

Financial products operate within environments where:

- trust is critical
- mistakes have real consequences
- regulation shapes interaction design
- users experience high decision anxiety

Retail investment products often create friction through:

- unclear processes
- overwhelming information density
- inconsistent experiences
- low confidence during critical decisions

The opportunity was to create investment journeys that felt:

- trustworthy
- understandable
- transparent
- operationally reliable

without compromising regulatory requirements.

The problem

Investment journeys involve significant operational and compliance complexity.

Users needed to:

- understand unfamiliar financial processes
- complete regulated onboarding steps
- navigate legal and identity requirements
- review financial information carefully
- make high-stakes decisions confidently

At the same time, internal stakeholders required:

- scalable systems
- consistent workflows
- operational visibility
- responsive product infrastructure

The challenge became:

How might we simplify regulated investment experiences while preserving trust, transparency and compliance?

Behavioural insights

Financial confidence is fragile

Users became hesitant when:

- workflows felt ambiguous
- terminology was unclear
- information hierarchy became overwhelming
- next steps were uncertain

Clarity and reassurance became critical interaction principles.

Trust is built through transparency

Customers responded more positively when:

- processes were clearly explained
- progress was visible
- system status was understandable
- decisions felt reversible where possible

Reducing uncertainty became more important than reducing information.

Operational complexity should stay invisible

Many financial workflows required complex backend coordination.

However, customers expected the experience to feel:

- seamless
- guided
- reliable
- simple to navigate

The design challenge was reducing perceived complexity without oversimplifying critical financial information.

Hypothesis

We believed that if we could:

- improve clarity across regulated workflows
- simplify financial interaction patterns
- create stronger system consistency

- and increase transparency throughout investment journeys

...we could improve customer confidence while supporting scalable financial operations.

Design principles

Design for trust first

Financial experiences should prioritise reassurance, transparency and confidence.

Simplify without hiding complexity

Users needed clarity — not oversimplification.

Create consistent interaction systems

Consistency reduces cognitive load in high-stakes environments.

Support operational scalability

The product needed to work across multiple financial workflows and internal teams.

The solution

I designed responsive investment experiences focused on:

- high-trust onboarding
- regulated transaction flows
- scalable financial systems
- operational clarity
- cross-platform consistency

The work spanned both:

- customer-facing investment journeys
 - internal broker and operational tools
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Responsive investment journeys

The investment experience was designed to support customers through:

- onboarding
- identity verification
- investment participation
- transaction review
- confirmation flows

Interaction patterns focused heavily on:

- information hierarchy
- progressive disclosure
- reassurance
- visibility of system state
- reducing decision anxiety

The goal was to make complex financial journeys feel structured and understandable.

Broker dashboard redesign

I also led the design of internal broker tooling focused on improving:

- operational visibility
- data comprehension
- workflow efficiency
- information architecture

The platform needed to support institutional stakeholders working across large volumes of financial data and operational processes.

Simplifying navigation and improving data clarity became central to the redesign.

Scalable design systems

A significant part of the work focused on creating reusable design systems across:

- customer-facing products
- broker tools
- responsive experiences

The system improved:

- interaction consistency
- development efficiency
- scalability

- cross-team collaboration

Reusable components helped standardise behaviour across high-risk workflows where consistency directly influenced user confidence.

Key product decisions

We prioritised clarity over feature density

Financial products often become overloaded with information.

Simplifying hierarchy and improving progression reduced cognitive overload significantly.

We used progressive disclosure heavily

Users did not need all information simultaneously.

Breaking complexity into structured steps improved comprehension and confidence.

We designed consistency intentionally

Repeated interaction patterns reduced uncertainty and improved trust across critical workflows.

Consistency became a behavioural trust mechanism.

We balanced customer and operational needs

Many decisions required balancing:

- regulatory requirements
- internal operational processes
- customer comprehension
- engineering scalability

The experience needed to work for both customers and financial operations simultaneously.

Validation & iteration

The product evolved through:

- stakeholder collaboration
- iterative refinement

- behavioural analysis
 - workflow testing
 - operational feedback
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Clarity improved confidence

Users responded positively when workflows felt:

- structured
- transparent
- predictable
- easy to follow

Reducing ambiguity became one of the strongest contributors to trust.

Consistency reduced cognitive load

Standardising interaction patterns improved usability across:

- onboarding
 - transaction flows
 - broker operations
 - responsive experiences
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Internal tooling improved operational efficiency

Improved information architecture and dashboard clarity helped internal stakeholders navigate financial data more effectively.

Impact

Improved trust across regulated journeys

The redesigned workflows created clearer and more understandable investment experiences.

Established scalable product foundations

The design system improved consistency and scalability across customer and broker products.

Simplified operational complexity

The redesigned broker tooling improved visibility and workflow efficiency for internal stakeholders.

Strengthened product maturity

The work helped evolve PrimaryBid's product ecosystem into a more cohesive, scalable and high-trust financial platform.

Reflection

The biggest learning was that designing financial products is fundamentally about designing confidence.

Users do not simply evaluate:

- features
- speed
- functionality

They evaluate:

- trust
- clarity
- reassurance
- predictability
- transparency

The project shifted the focus from:

"How do we simplify finance?"

to:

"How do we help people feel confident navigating complex financial systems?"

Designing within regulated environments required balancing:

- compliance with usability
- complexity with clarity
- operational requirements with customer trust

The result was a more structured and scalable investment experience designed around confidence, transparency and consistency.

Core skills demonstrated

- Product strategy
- Fintech UX
- Regulated product design
- Systems thinking
- Information architecture
- Design systems
- Responsive product design
- Behavioural UX
- High-trust interaction design
- Dashboard design
- Workflow optimisation
- Cross-functional collaboration
- Stakeholder management
- Data-informed product design